

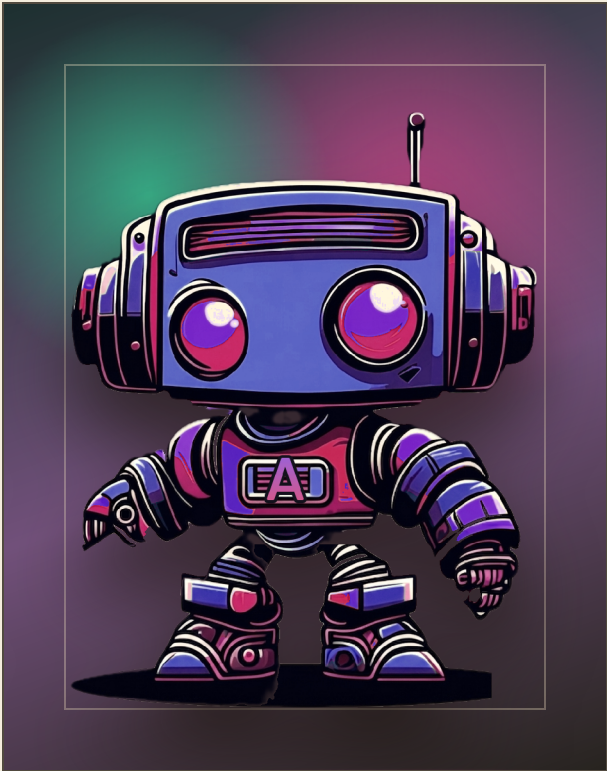
OWNER MANUAL / RELEASE 0.68

MAKE RECALL PART OF THE PATH

Aperio gives every agent one durable, self-hosted memory. This manual gets you from first launch to verified recall, then stays beside you for operation, recovery, and contribution.

[Start in 10 minutes](#)

[Choose your route](#)



Aperio listens for what matters, then helps the next conversation remember it.

/// CHOOSE A FREQUENCY

01 First recall
Install,
connect,
remember

02 Operate
Configure,
update,
recover

03 Integrate
MCP,
automation,
internals



10 MINUTE FAST PATH

Store one memory. Recall it later.

This path proves the whole loop before you tune anything. You are done when a fresh conversation retrieves a detail that was not copied into its prompt.



Success / finish line. A second conversation recalls the marina gate code after the first conversation has ended.

1. Keep the first setup local

Create `.env` with the smallest useful configuration:

```
AI_PROVIDER=llamacpp
DB_BACKEND=sqlite
EMBEDDING_PROVIDER=transformers
```

1

Start Aperio

Run the normal start command and wait for the connected state.

```
npm start
```

2

Connect an agent

Add Aperio as an MCP server, then confirm its memory tools are visible.

3

Prove recall

Store a harmless fact, end the chat, and ask a fresh chat for it.



Caution / keep secrets off the air. Test with a harmless fact. Do not store passwords, API keys, or recovery codes as a recall check.

Nothing came back?

[Check indexing](#)

[Search exact text](#)

[Inspect provider state](#)

02

ONE TASK, LABELED DIFFERENCES

Put the configuration where Aperio reads it

The decision is shared across platforms; only the file path and service controls differ.

MACOS Apple silicon and Intel	Use the project <code>.env</code> , then allow Keychain access if database encryption is enabled.	<pre>cp .env.example .env</pre>
WINDOWS PowerShell	Use the same project file. Keep UTF-8 encoding and avoid a hidden <code>.txt</code> suffix.	<pre>Copy-Item .env.example .env</pre>
LINUX Desktop or server	Use the project file for an interactive install or the service environment for a daemon.	<pre>cp .env.example .env</pre>

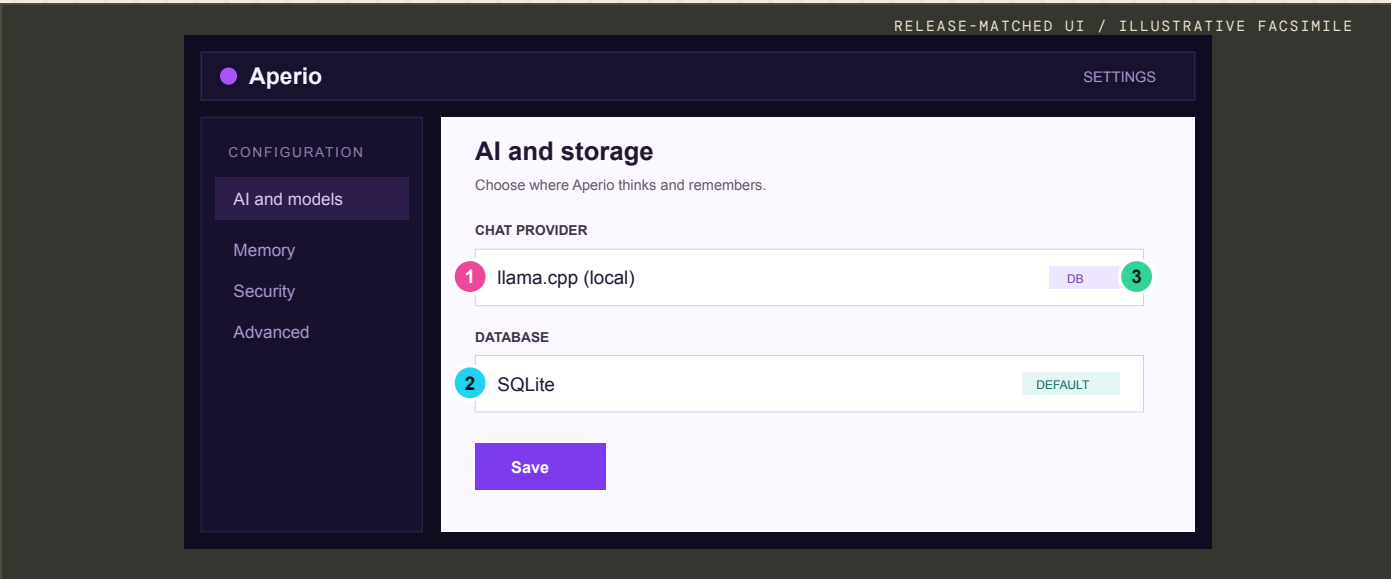


Figure 2.1 Use numbered pins only where the image removes ambiguity. The procedure remains complete without the screenshot.

- 1

Provider. Choose where chat inference runs.
- 2

Storage. SQLite is the zero-configuration default.
- 3

Source badge. Confirm whether the value came from DB, environment, or default.

03

UNDERSTAND ENOUGH TO RECOVER

Follow a memory through the receiver

Every layer has one job and one piece of evidence. Trace the signal in order; do not change thresholds until you know which layer failed.

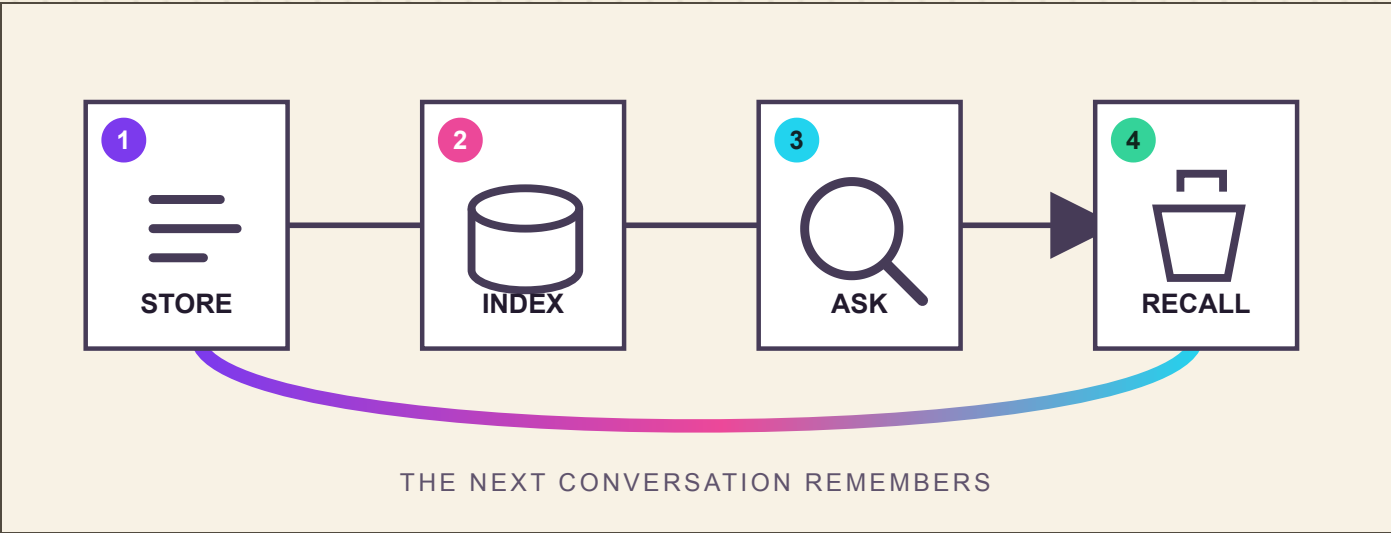


Figure 3.1 The recall path. Shape, labels, and numbering carry the meaning without relying on aurora color.

LAYER	OWNS	EVIDENCE WHEN HEALTHY	FIRST RECOVERY MOVE
Agent	Tool request and useful context	Memory tool returns a stable ID	Confirm the MCP connection
Aperio	Validation and durable write	Record exists with expected scope	Search a distinctive phrase
Embedder	Searchable vector representation	Queue reaches completed state	Inspect provider and queue state
Recall	Ranking and context delivery	Relevant memory enters the next turn	Compare exact and semantic search



/// APERIO SAYS

Trace before tuning. If exact search works but semantic recall does not, the useful evidence is between storage and embedding – not in the ranking threshold.

Troubleshooting by symptom

A

No tools appear
Check the MCP connection and server command.

B

Exact search is empty
Check write acceptance, scope, and database state.

C

Semantic recall is empty
Check the embedding provider and queue.